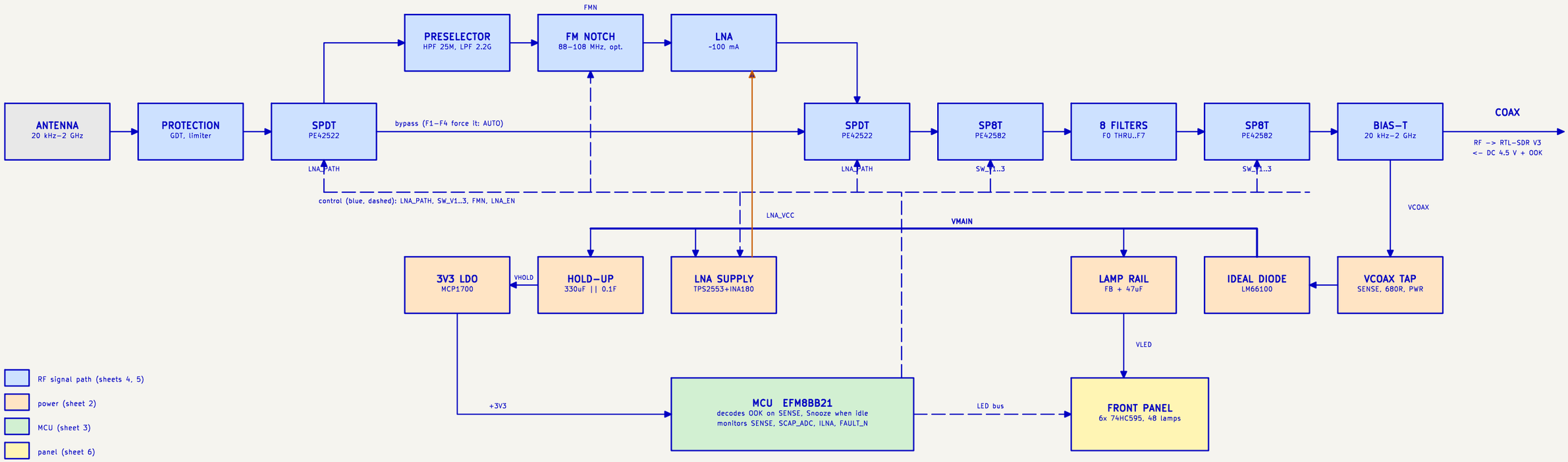
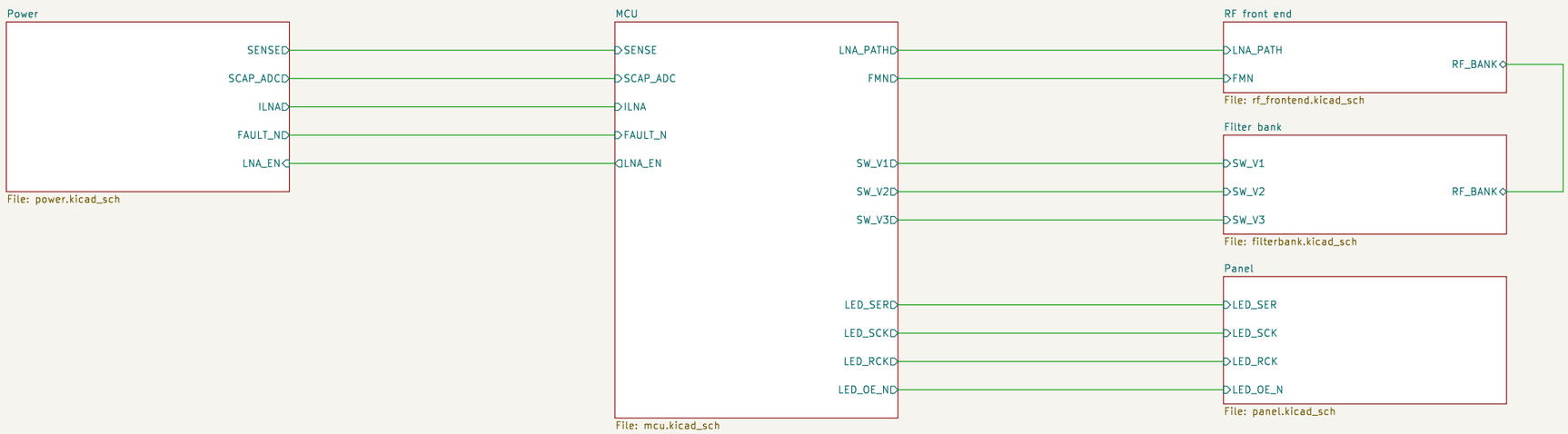
Coaxolotl — block diagram



Sheets

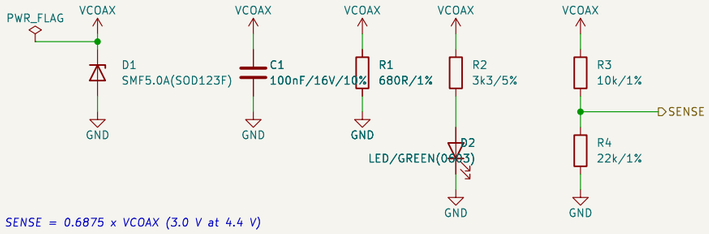


Power and ground cross sheets only as power symbols (VCOAX, VMAIN, VHOLD, VLED, LNA_VCC, +3V3, GND).
Signals cross sheets as hierarchical labels through the sheet pins above. Firmware pin map: firmware/src/hal_efm8bb2.c

Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
Bias-T powered, OOK switched LNA + 8-way filter bank
z2labs

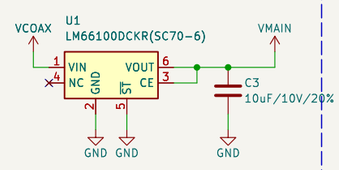
Sheet: /		
File: coaxolotl.kicad_sch		
Title: Coaxolotl		
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 1/6

VCOAX tap



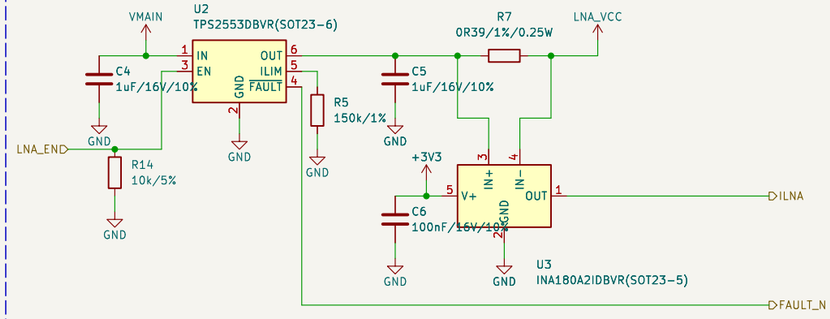
SENSE = 0.6875 x VCOAX (3.0 V at 4.4 V)
t_fall = 1.1 x R_eff x C_total: R1 sets the OOK falling edge

Ideal diode



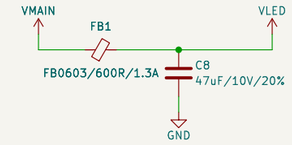
CE = VOUT: comparator blocks
reverse current in OOK gaps

LNA supply + current monitor



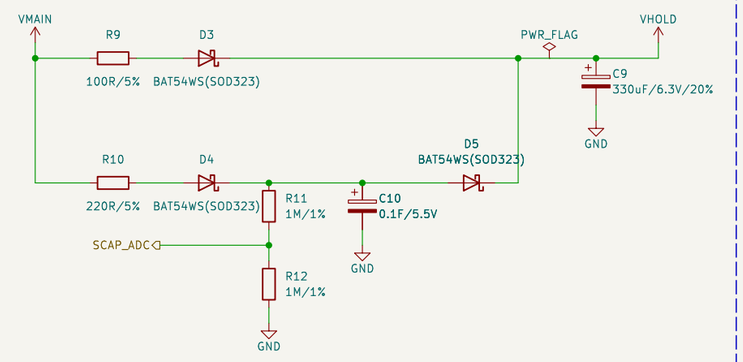
Ilim = f(R5), TPS2553 Eq.1: VERIFY IOS(min) > 130 mA
ILNA = 0.39R x 50 V/V = 19.5 mV/mA (100 mA -> 1.95 V); Kelvin taps at R7 pads

Lamp rail



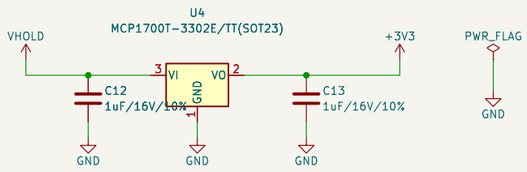
48 lamps x 1 mA max on VMAIN:
dark in OOK gaps, no hold-up drain

Hold-up (diode-OR)



fast path R9/D3: VHOLD up in ~30 ms (100R x 330uF) -> MCU boots
slow path R10/D4: tau ~22 s (220R x 0.1F); ride-through ~4 min at 0.6 mA
SCAP_ADC = VSCAP / 2 (HOLD lamp at >= 3.6 V)

3V3 regulator



MCP1700: Iq 1.6 uA, dropout 178 mV;
VO needs >= 1 uF ceramic

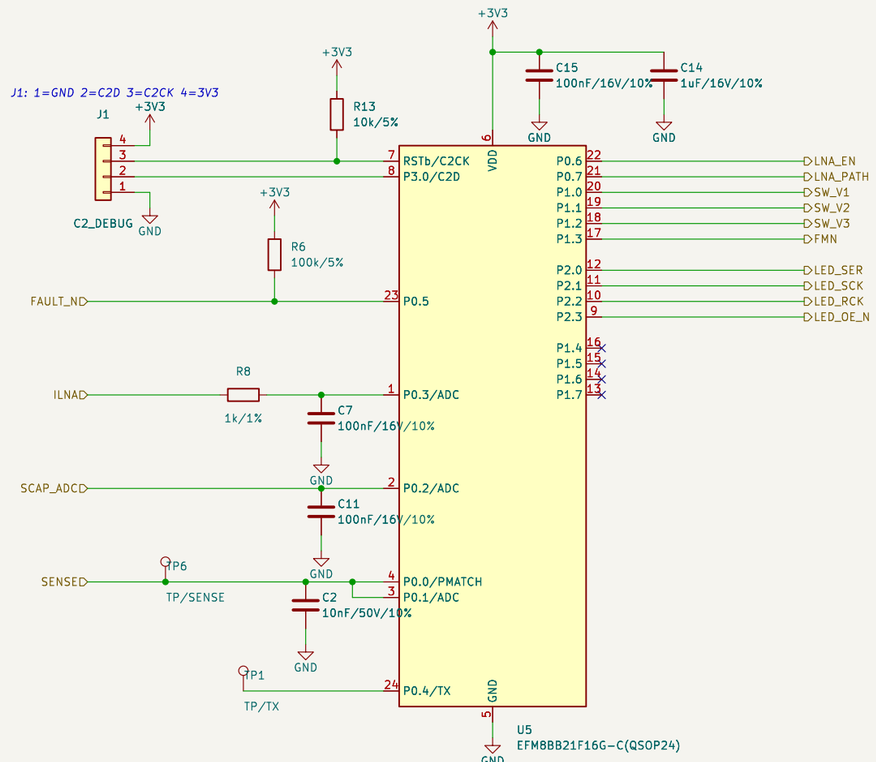
Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
VCOAX tap, ideal diode, LNA supply switch + current monitor, lamp rail, hold-up, 3V3
z2labs

Sheet: /Power/
File: power.kicad_sch

Title: Power

Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 2/6

MCU



Pinout follows placement: QSOP pins 1–12 (ADC, debug, lamp chain P2.x) face power panel,
pins 13–24 (switch control, LNA_EN, FAULT_N) face the RF chain: no line crosses the MCU.
SYSCLK = HFOSC0/8 = 3.0625 MHz, Snooze when idle (no clock, no spurs). ILNA RC: fc = 1.6 kHz

Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
EFM8BB21F16G, C2 debug, ADC input conditioning
z2labs

Sheet: /MCU/		
File: mcu.kicad_sch		
Title: MCU		
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 3/6

Antenna input + protection

J2
SMA/EDGE(ANT)
GDT1
GDT/90V
D6
BAV99W(SOT323)
R23
100k/5%
GDT 90 V, BAV99 low-C clamp, 100k bleed

LNA/BYP IN

C36
100nF/16V/10%
U6
PE42522B(LGA29)

bypass: F1–F4 (HF/LF) always, LNA off or tripped

LNA/BYP OUT

C37
100nF/16V/10%
U7
PE42522B(LGA29)
RF_BANK

Preselector (LNA path only)

HPF: 5th-order Butterworth T, fc ~25 MHz *LPF: LTCC, fc ~2.2 GHz*

C24
200pF/50V/C0G
C25
68pF/50V/C0G
C26
200pF/50V/C0G
L1
220nH/5%
L2
220nH/5%
U12
LFCN-2250+(FV1206)
R22
0R/0603

LNA

LNA_VCC
FB2
FBO603/600R/1.3A
C30
10uF/10V/20%
L4
1uH/BROADBAND
C28
100nF/16V/X7R
C31
100nF/16V/X7R
U13
LNA_MMIC(TBD,~100mA)
bias via RFOUT; add 100 pF || for > 1 GHz

FM notch (DNP option)

U9
NA(PE42522B)
L3
NA(56nH/2%)
C27
NA(47pF/C0G)
U10
NA(PE42522B)
tank 56 nH || 47 pF: f0 = 98 MHz

Control inputs (reset-safe pull-downs)

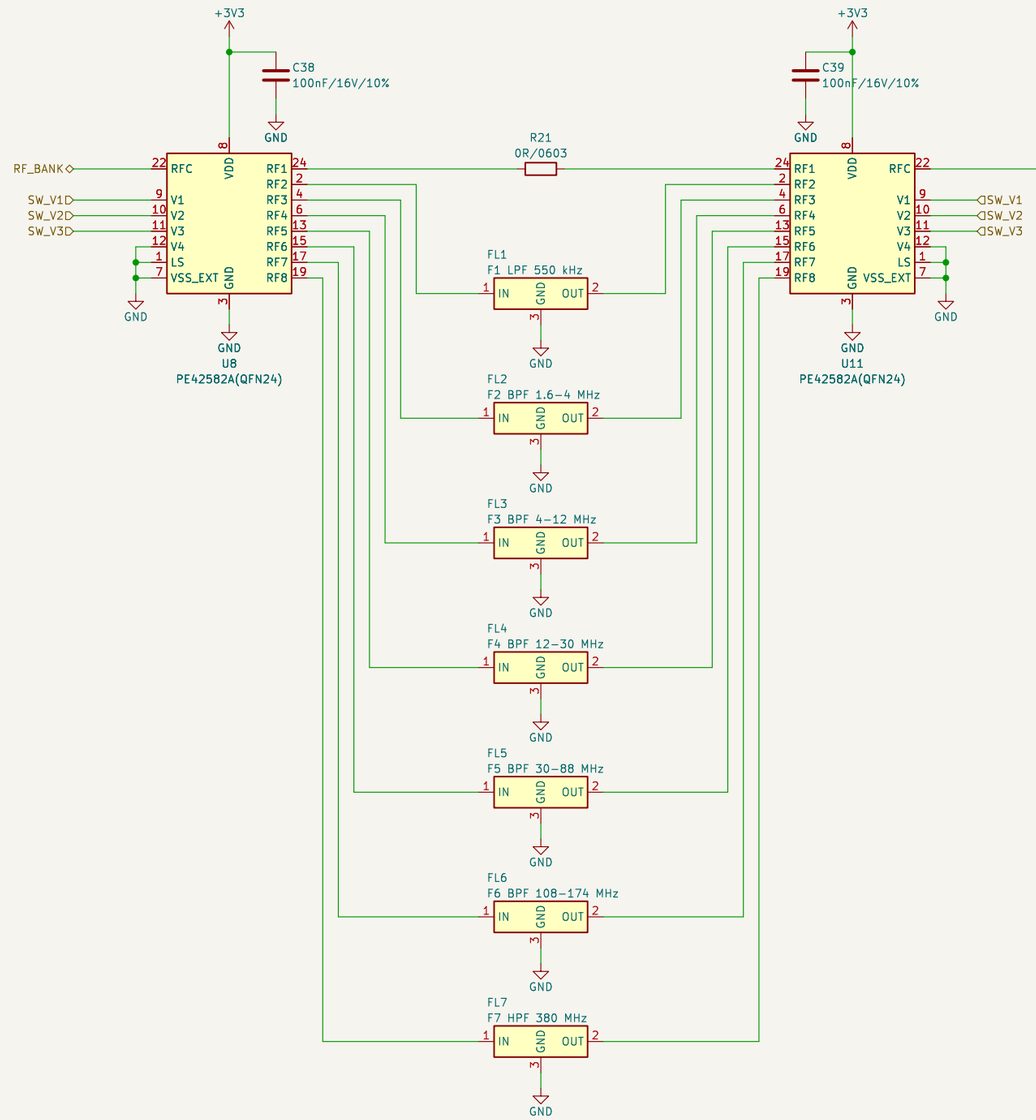
FMN
R19
10k/5%
LNA_PATH
R15
10k/5%

LNA_PATH: 0 = RF1 = bypass, 1 = RF2 = LNA. FMN: 0 = RF1 = through, 1 = RF2 = notch.
PE42522 RF ports sit at 0 VDC: no blocking caps except around the LNA.

Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
Antenna protection, LNA/bypass select, preselector, FM notch option, LNA
z2labs

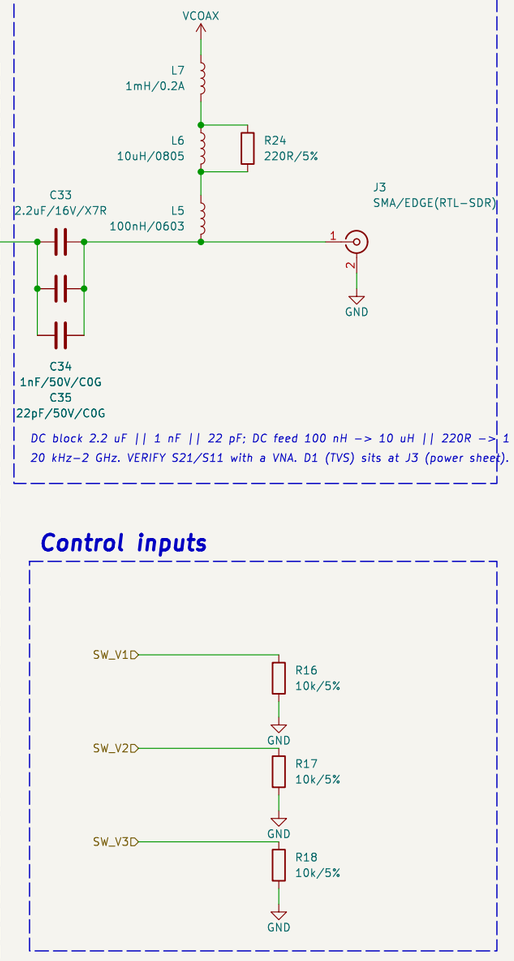
Sheet: /RF front end/		
File: rf_frontend.kicad_sch		
Title: RF front end		
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 4/6

Filter bank



Branch k on RFk+1 of both switches. LS = 0 code (V3 V2 V1) per RF port: RF1 000, RF2 100, RF3 010, RF4 110, RF5 001, RF6 101, RF7 011, RF8 111
bandplan.json 'port' -> code mapping is done in tools/gen_bandplan.py. V4 = LS = VSS_EXT = GND (all-off unused, internal negative generator).
Reset: V = 000 -> RF1 = F0 THRU (straight through).

Bias-T + coax to RTL-SDR



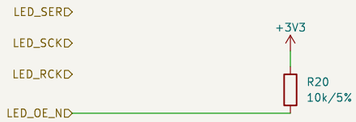
DC block 2.2 uF || 1 nF || 22 pF; DC feed 100 nH -> 10 uH || 220R -> 1 mH:
20 kHz–2 GHz. VERIFY S21/S11 with a VNA. D1 (TVS) sits at J3 (power sheet).

Control inputs

Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
2x PE42582 SP8T, 8 filter branches, bias-T, coax
z2labs

Sheet: /Filter bank/		
File: filterbank.kicad_sch		
Title: Filter bank		
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 5/6

Lamp chain inputs



NEXT REVIEW: 6x 74HC595 (sinking), 48 lamps on VLED, 2.2k arrays.

Generated by hardware/kicad/tools/build.py — edit the Python, not this file
48-lamp front panel — placeholder (next review)

z2labs

Sheet: /Panel/		
File: panel.kicad_sch		
Title: Panel		
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-26	**Rev: 0.2**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 6/6